

Component 3: Theatre Makers in Practice

Overview

Theatre is a collaborative art form and it is important that students have a clear understanding of how different creative ideas are put into practice. This component requires students to consider, analyse and evaluate how different theatre makers create impact. Throughout this component, students will consider how production ideas and dramatic elements are communicated to an audience from the perspective of a director, a performer and a designer.

Students will critically analyse and evaluate their experience of live performance. As an informed member of the audience they will deconstruct theatrical elements which will help inform their own production choices and develop their own ideas as potential theatre makers.

Students will practically explore texts in order to demonstrate how ideas for performance and production might be realised from page to stage. They will also consider the methodologies of practitioners and interpret texts in order to justify their own ideas for a production concept. Students will research the original performance conditions and gain an understanding of how social, historical and cultural contexts have informed their decisions as theatre makers.

Content

There are **three** areas to be covered.

- 1) A live theatre evaluation.
- 2) Page to stage: realisation of a complete performance text.
- 3) Interpreting **one complete** performance text, in light of **one practitioner** for a contemporary audience.

1) Live Theatre Evaluation

Students will reflect on their experience as an informed member of an audience watching a theatre performance, enabling them to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of performance through analysis and evaluation. When choosing a performance the following criteria should be taken into consideration.

- While both amateur and professional productions are acceptable, it is not acceptable to evaluate the work of other students for this assessment.
- The live theatre performance cannot be a performance text that is on the prescribed list of this specification.
- It should ideally demonstrate a range of production elements e.g. costume, set, sound, and lighting.
- The production should present opportunities for students to discuss the work of key theatre makers, for example directors, performers and designers.
- The production must provide opportunities for students to use a subject-specific vocabulary.

For the purposes of this qualification, live theatre means being a member of the audience in the same performance space as the performers. It does **not** include any performance that is sung-through in its entirety. The performance can be an amateur or professional production as long as the choice enables students to access the demands of this component.

It is desirable for students to see as much live theatre as possible throughout the course, although only **one** performance will be written about in the examination.

Centres are reminded that they must submit a live performance statement to Pearson (please see *page 8* for details). If there are extreme extenuating circumstances regarding the access to live theatre for this component, then centres are required to contact drama.assessment@pearson.com.

Notes

Students are allowed to bring in theatre evaluation notes of up to a maximum of 500 words. These notes must be focused on **one** performance only and include the details of the title, venue and date seen. These notes should help them to demonstrate knowledge and understanding as an informed member of the audience.

These notes may include reference to:

- performers, including performers in specific roles
- design considerations, including the use of costume, set, lighting and sound
- the director's concept/interpretation and the chosen performance style
- impact on the audience, including, specifically, on the student, and how this was achieved
- the use of the theatre space
- how ideas were communicated during the performance.

Sketches, drawings and diagrams may also be included in the notes and used to support the response to the question if required.

No pre-published material, including programmes and photographs, may be taken into the examination or form part of the notes.

Notes may be handwritten or word processed but the total word limit must not be exceeded.

Notes must not be submitted with the examination paper, but retained by the centre and kept until after post-results services deadline.

The notes must be attached to the form provided in *Appendix 2*.

Knowledge and understanding

Students are required to:

- understand the processes and practices used in 21st-century theatre making
- participate as an informed member of the audience while watching live theatre
- understand and experience the collaborative relationship between various roles in theatre
- understand how choices made by directors, performers and designers influence how meaning and ideas are communicated to an audience
- make critical and evaluative judgements that show understanding of how the meaning of a text might be interpreted and communicated to an audience
- how meaning is conveyed through:
 - the use of performance space and spatial relationships on stage
 - the relationships between performers and audience
 - the performer's vocal and physical interpretation of character
- know, understand and use relevant subject-specific terminology.

Skills

Students must acquire, develop and apply skills in:

- interpreting, analysing and evaluating the work of various theatre makers
- forming critical judgements about live theatre, based on their understanding of drama and theatre

- analysing the ways in which different performance and production elements are brought together to create theatre
- using of subject-specific terminology in a range of contexts.

2) Page to Stage: realisation of one key extract from a performance text

Students must practically explore a performance text (from list A below) to consider how theatrical ideas might be realised in performance and communicated to an audience. They will need to consider how performers and designers use theatrical conventions and dramatic elements to realise ideas from the page to the stage.

Students will respond to an **unseen extract** from their chosen performance text in the examination. They will be asked to consider a possible staging of the selected unseen extract and the intended impact their creative ideas will have on an audience.

The unseen extract will be from a scene or moment that is significant to the text as a whole. Extracts will normally be between 80–110 lines long (this includes spoken dialogue and stage directions). Please note performance texts are not permitted in the examination.

Centres must choose **one** of the following performance texts.

Performance text (List A)	Prescribed edition*
<i>Accidental Death Of An Anarchist</i> , Dario Fo (adapted by Gavin Richards)	Methuen Drama ISBN 9780413156105
<i>Colder Than Here</i> , Laura Wade	Oberon Modern Plays ISBN 9781840024715
<i>Equus</i> , Peter Shaffer	Penguin Classics ISBN 9780141188904
<i>Fences</i> , August Wilson	Penguin Books Ltd (reissue edition 1991) ISBN 9780452264014
<i>Machinal</i> , Sophie Treadwell	Nick Hern Books ISBN 9781854592118
<i>That Face</i> , Polly Stenham	Faber & Faber ISBN 9780571244218

*The prescribed editions will be used to reproduce extracts for examination purposes. Centres are free to choose a different edition for teaching purposes.

Centres are reminded that they must complete a form regarding text choice, please refer to *page 7* for details.

Practical work should include, as appropriate, the exploration of:

- characterisation of key roles including the use of physicality and voice
- staging, levels and proxemics
- stage space
- entrances and exits
- visual and non-verbal forms of communication
- design elements
- relationship between actor and audience
- ways in which the playwright has structured the text and uses elements such as plot, language, form, genre, structure, characterisation and stage directions to communicate ideas
- mood and atmosphere
- performance style and use of theatrical devices
- relevant subject-specific vocabulary.

Knowledge and understanding

Students are required to:

- make creative decisions and theatrical choices as theatre makers
- explore in depth the ways in which theatre makers collaborate to create theatre by understanding how performers and designers use dramatic elements to communicate meaning and ideas to an audience
- have a knowledge of production values and be able to make clear choices about how a performance text might be realised in performance
- consider how language, genre, form and characterisation might be explored in performance
- consider how elements such as theatrical space, set, staging, lighting, sound, multimedia, masks, costume, puppets and props might be used in performance to communicate meaning to an audience
- know and understand appropriate subject-specific terminology.

Skills

Students must acquire, develop and apply skills in:

- forming critical judgements about the practice of theatre makers based on their understanding of drama and theatre
- responding to texts imaginatively conveying ideas clearly and coherently
- practically exploring the use of voice, movement, staging and characterisation
- practically exploring ways in which the ideas of key theatre makers are realised in performance
- the use of an appropriate subject-specific terminology
- analysing the ways in which different performance and production elements are brought together to create theatre.

3) Interpreting one performance text, in the light of one practitioner for a contemporary audience

Students must practically explore **a complete performance text** (from list B on the next page) in the light of a chosen practitioner (from the list on the next page) in order to outline and justify their ideas for a production concept. They will need to develop an integral understanding of the text as a whole in order to interpret it for a contemporary audience. Students will assume the role of a director and will need to outline and justify how different theatre makers and theatrical elements work alongside the methodologies of a recognised theatre practitioner. The practitioner chosen for this component needs to be different from the one studied in Component 1 (see *pages 6 and 7*).

Students must also research the original performance conditions and gain knowledge and understanding of the social, historical and cultural factors that are central to the context of the original text.

Interpreting a performance text may or may not include changes to performance style, historical period or setting. However, whilst changes and edits to the structure of the text are allowed, it is not an opportunity to cut the language or alter the meaning of the original text.

It is also important that students have an appreciation of the original aims and intentions of the playwright. In whatever way the production is interpreted by the student, the audience will always be contemporary (a 21st-century audience).

Students may prepare a director's script that will help them consider how their chosen text might be interpreted as a complete performance.

When considering how their chosen performance text might be interpreted and staged in the light of a practitioner students should consider:

- their intended audience and an appropriate theatrical venue/space
- staging and visual impact
- how the use of design elements such as set, lighting, sound, costume, multimedia, masks, props and puppets might help to communicate ideas to an audience
- the acting style of key roles including the use of characterisation, vocal expression and movement
- the original performance conditions and the historical, social and cultural context of the text.

Practical work should, as appropriate, include exploration of:

- characterisation of key roles
- staging and space
- visual communication
- design elements
- relationship between actor and audience
- ways in which the playwright has structured the text and uses elements such as plot, language, form, structure, characterisation and stage directions to communicate ideas to an audience
- mood and atmosphere
- performance style and theatrical devices
- practitioner methodology
- historical, social and cultural context and its relevance to themselves and a contemporary audience
- relevant subject-specific vocabulary.

Centres must choose **one** of the following performance texts to study.

Performance text (List B)	Recommended edition
<i>Antigone</i> , Sophocles (adapted by Don Taylor)	Methuen ISBN 9780413776044
<i>Doctor Faustus</i> , Christopher Marlowe*†	Norton & Company ISBN 9780393977547
<i>Hedda Gabler</i> , Henrik Ibsen (adapted by Richard Eyre)	Nick Hern Books ISBN 9781854598424
<i>Lysistrata</i> , Aristophanes (translated by Alan H. Sommerstein)†	Penguin Classics ISBN 9780140448146
<i>The Maids</i> , Jean Genet (translated by Bernard Frechtman)	Faber & Faber ISBN: 9780571251148
<i>The School for Scandal</i> , Richard Brinsley Sheridan	Dover Thrift ISBN 9780486266879
<i>The Tempest</i> , William Shakespeare	Oxford School Shakespeare ISBN: 9780198325000
<i>Waiting for Godot</i> , Samuel Beckett	Faber & Faber ISBN 9780571229116
<i>Woyzeck</i> , Georg Büchner (translated by John Mackendrick)†	Berg Publishing ISBN 9780413388209

* This edition has two versions of the text and centres should use Text A only

† These texts are available as PDF downloads from the Pearson [website](#).

In the examination the page numbers from both the recommended editions and the PDF versions will be given.

Students **must** take clean copies of list B texts into the examination. Students will respond to an **unseen named section** from their chosen performance text in the examination.

The **unseen named section** will normally be between 90-110 lines long.

It is strongly recommended that the editions above are used by centres as these will be used to specify page references for each **unseen named section** in the examination.

The centre must ensure that only clean copies are used in the examination. Clean copies of prescribed texts must be checked prior to entering the examination and if texts are found to not be clean, then the copy must be taken from the student. Any infringements of this requirement found during the examination must be reported to Pearson and will be treated as a malpractice issue.

Practitioners

The practitioner chosen from the list below should be different to the one studied in Component 1.

Antonin Artaud	Kneehigh
Bertolt Brecht	Joan Littlewood
Steven Berkoff	Punchdrunk
Complicite	Constantin Stanislavski

Centres are reminded that they must complete a form regarding text and practitioner choices, please refer to *page 7* for details.

Knowledge and understanding

Students are required to:

- explore a complete and substantial set text from the viewpoint of a theatre director
- make creative decisions and theatrical choices as a theatre director
- demonstrate an understanding of production methods used to communicate a directorial concept and interpretation to an audience
- explore and develop ideas that will shape a complete production concept and interpretation
- understand how directors communicate ideas to an audience and how the meaning of a text might be interpreted and communicated to an audience
- participate in practical exploration that considers the ways in which the playwright has structured the text and uses plot, language, form, structure, characterisation and stagecraft to communicate ideas to an audience
- consider how the application of dramatic elements (for example, physicality, vocal expression, set, sound, light, costume, masks, puppets, props and space) contribute to the development and shaping of ideas in performance
- develop an understanding and appreciation of how practitioner theory and practice has influenced the development of drama and theatre
- consider how the work of a chosen theatre practitioner might inform or influence a production concept of their chosen text
- explore the potential for staging texts, taking into consideration any relevant stage directions
- develop an understanding of historical, social and cultural contexts including the original performance conditions
- know and understanding appropriate subject-specific terminology.

Students must acquire knowledge and understanding of how their chosen practitioner has used the following to convey meaning through:

- the social and historical contexts that shaped the theatre practice
- the ideas, theatrical purpose, practice and working methodologies underpinning their work
- the realisation of their artistic intention
- the use of theatrical style and conventions
- collaboration with and influence on other practitioners
- how the relationship with audiences is defined in theory and then carried out in practice.

Skills

Students must acquire, develop and apply skills in:

- forming critical judgements about the practice of theatre makers based on their understanding of drama and theatre
- responding to texts imaginatively conveying ideas clearly and coherently
- practically exploring the use of voice, movement, staging and characterisation
- practically exploring ways in which the ideas of the director are interpreted in performance
- the use of an appropriate subject-specific terminology
- analysing the ways in which different performance and production elements are brought together to create theatre
- applying practitioner methodology to their own dramatic interpretations
- using research to develop ideas in a variety of contexts.